

SINGAPORE BANKS

4Q25 preview: Weaker 4Q due to seasonality

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Capital return plans remain a focus

Increasing capital return has been a key driver of Singapore banks performance. We expect the banks to continue to optimise balance sheets in an environment of moderating loan growth and decent/robust profitability. For OCBC, following the announced 10% special dividend payout for 2024 and 2025, we expect management to extend its special dividend framework into 2026 and 2027 given their robust capital structure and decent ROEs which we have incorporated into our forecasts. For DBS, we expect continued progressive dividend policy with annual core DPS increase of S\$0.24 extending through 2028, supported by structurally strong ROEs and capital buffers. UOB is expected to maintain its 50% payout ratio.

Remain positive on Singapore banks; Buy DBS, OCBC

Despite on average share price increases of 11% in 4Q25 and 4% in 2026 YTD, we believe the valuations remain undemanding compared with global peers of similar profitability profiles, supported by sustained earnings momentum and attractive return metrics. We maintain a favorable outlook on Singapore banks. As such, we remain Buy on DBS given its robust and sustainable profitability, and decent capital returns, and OCBC as we expect improving momentum in wealth and strong deposit growth of OCBC to help support its profitability, and potential positive catalyst from recent management change.

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4Q25 Preview: weaker 4Q due to seasonality

Singapore banks will be reporting their 4Q25 financials starting with DBS on Feb 9th, followed by UOB on Feb 24th and OCBC on Feb 25th. For 4Q, we expect PPOPs to decline by -13% qoq, mainly due to: **1) Lower qoq fee income** mainly due to slower usual seasonality in 4Q and lower investment sentiment, as evident in -20% qoq decline in HKex ADTV; **2) Lower other non-interest income** as investment gains are expected to normalize from high levels in 3Q25; **3) Seasonally higher opex** but still well-controlled. These headwinds are expected to be partially offset by: **4) Flattish NIMs in 4Q**, with sharp rebound in HIBOR to offset the impact from SORA decline; **5) Lower credit cost qoq**, largely due to normalization of UOB credit cost to guided range, and we remain within banks' guidance range for DBS and OCBC, reflecting our conservative stance. We expect DBS to see the largest qoq net income decline of -17% qoq while UOB to see significant improvement of +443% qoq.

- **DBS:** We forecast 4Q25 net profit of S\$2,446mn (-17% qoq/-3% yoy), with ROE of 14.9%. On a qoq basis, the decline in bottom line is primarily driven by 22% qoq decline in fee income, attributable to usual slower seasonality in 4Q and lower investment sentiment, evident in the -20% qoq decline of HKEX ADTV. In addition, we expect other non-NII to normalize from the historical high level in 3Q25, resulting in a 15% qoq decline. With that said, we expect NII to partly offset the decline with 1% qoq increase, on the back of +1% qoq loan growth, and NIM of 1.92%, flat from Oct exit level and down 4bps qoq. This resilience in margin is underpinned by a notable 110 bps qoq rebound in the 1M HIBOR, which is expected to largely mitigate the pressure stemming from a 44 bps qoq decline in the 3M SORA. We expect asset quality to remain stable and have incorporated a credit cost forecast of 20bps, at the higher end of the guidance range of 17-20bps.
- **OCBC:** We forecast 4Q25 net profit of S\$1,702mn (-14% qoq/ +1% yoy). Similar to DBS, we anticipate that lower non-NII will be the primary factor dragging down net profit. We expect fee income to decline by 20% qoq driven by seasonality and sentiment, and other non-NII to decline by 30% qoq, due to a normalization of profits from the insurance business. We expect NII to be flattish on the back of flattish NIM of 1.83%, 1bps lower than 3Q25 and Sep exit of 1.84%, with sharp rebound of HIBOR to offset decrease in SORA. Our credit cost forecast is 20bps, an increase from 17bps in 3Q25, and within the company's guidance of 20-25bps, as we expect asset quality to remain manageable.
- **UOB:** We forecast 4Q net profit of S\$1,343mn (+443% qoq/ -2% yoy). The significant sequential improvement is driven by the expected normalization of credit cost, to 30bps in 4Q25, aligning with bank guidance range of 25-30bps. This normalization follows the significant pre-emptive provisions made in 3Q25 to enhance GP coverage to 1%, which management deems sufficient at the moment. For PPOP, we expect 1% qoq/ -1% yoy, supported by +4% qoq fee income growth, as we expect the fee income of UOB to be less impacted by seasonality given its more conservative strategy. We expect NIM of UOB also be flattish, similar to DBS and OCBC, at 1.82%, flat from 3Q25 and Sep exit. Operating expenses are expected to be well-controlled at +1% qoq and -1% yoy.

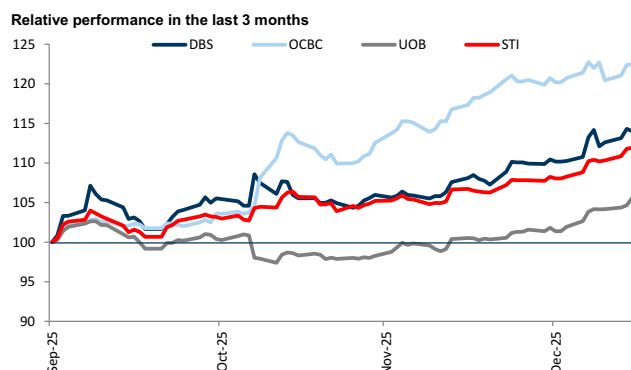
Exhibit 1: Singapore banks' results preview

S\$mn	DBS					OCBC					UOB				
	4Q25E	3Q25	QoQ (%)	4Q24	YoY (%)	4Q25E	3Q25	QoQ (%)	4Q24	YoY (%)	4Q25E	3Q25	QoQ (%)	4Q24	YoY (%)
NII	3,612	3,578	1.0	3,728	(3.1)	2,230	2,226	0.2	2,455	(9.2)	2,320	2,265	2.4	2,452	(5.4)
Fee Income	1,054	1,357	(22.3)	968	8.9	546	683	(20.0)	517	5.7	637	615	3.6	567	12.3
Other Non-NII	843	997	(15.4)	809	4.2	681	974	(30.1)	444	53.3	466	518	(10.0)	442	5.4
Non- NII	1,897	2,354	(19.4)	1,777	6.8	1,227	1,657	(25.9)	961	27.7	1,103	1,133	(2.7)	1,009	9.3
Operating Expenses	(2,463)	(2,393)	2.9	(2,395)	2.8	(1,591)	(1,519)	4.8	(1,560)	2.0	(1,542)	(1,535)	0.5	(1,559)	(1.1)
PPOP	3,047	3,539	(13.9)	3,110	(2.0)	1,866	2,364	(21.1)	1,856	0.5	1,881	1,863	1.0	1,902	(1.1)
Impairment charges	(217)	(124)	75.4	(209)	4.0	(163)	(139)	17.1	(208)	(21.8)	(265)	(1,361)	(80.5)	(227)	16.8
Pre-tax Profit	2,908	3,482	(16.5)	2,960	(1.8)	1,952	2,480	(21.3)	1,887	3.5	1,632	520	213.8	1,685	(3.2)
Net Profit	2,446	2,954	(17.2)	2,523	(3.0)	1,702	1,978	(14.0)	1,687	0.9	1,343	443	203.1	1,522	(11.8)
Core Net Profit	2,546	2,954	(13.8)	2,623	(2.9)	1,702	1,978	(14.0)	1,687	0.9	1,343	443	203.1	1,539	(12.8)
Reported NIM (%)	1.92	1.96	-4bp	2.15	-23bp	1.83	1.84	-1bp	2.15	-32bp	1.82	1.82	0bp	2.00	-18bp
Credit Costs (bps)	20	11	8bp	19	0bp	20	17	3bp	27	-7bp	30	157	-127bp	27	3bp
Cost-to-income Ratio	45	40	4pp	44	1pp	46	39	7pp	46	0pp	45	45	0pp	45	0pp
Gross Loans	448,276	443,000	1.2	436,684	2.7	330,303	327,000	1.0	319,166	3.5	354,487	351,084	1.0	337,831	4.9
ROA (%)	1.15	1.37	-22bp	1.30	-15bp	1.04	1.22	-18bp	1.10	-6bp	0.93	0.32	61bp	1.10	-18bp
ROE (%)	14.9	17.5	-253bp	16.0	-107bp	11.5	13.6	-206bp	11.9	-35bp	10.9	3.7	721bp	12.8	-195bp

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

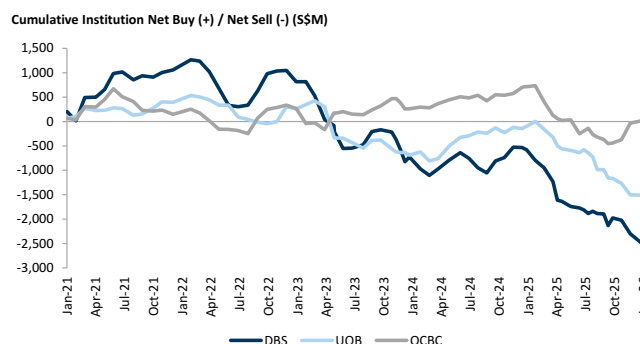
4Q25 in six charts

Exhibit 2: DBS and OCBC share prices outperformed STI in 4Q25



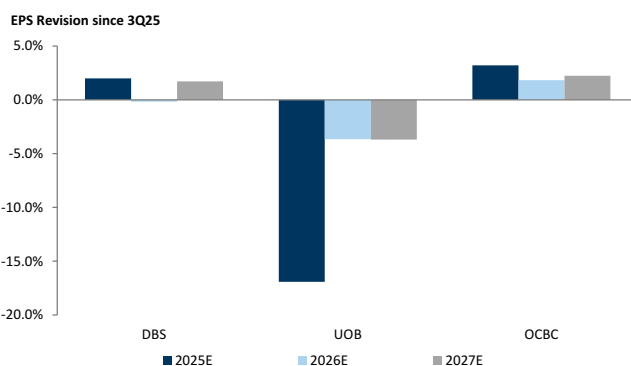
Source: Thomson Reuters, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: OCBC saw inflows from institutional investors in 4Q25 while the other 2 saw outflows



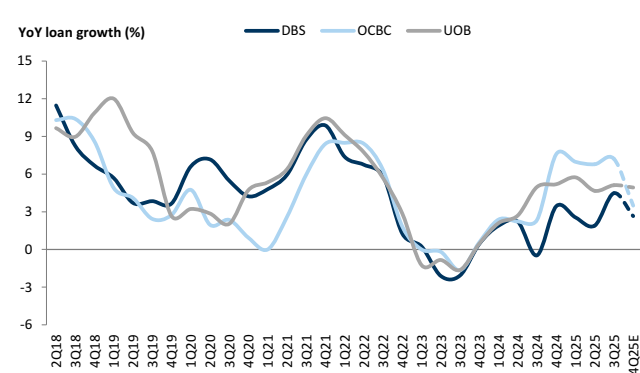
Source: SGX, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Consensus EPS have been revised up for DBS and OCBC, but down for UOB



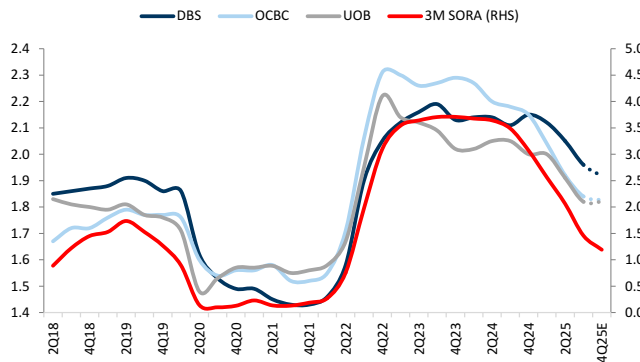
Source: Bloomberg

Exhibit 5: We anticipate credit growth to remain at mid to low single-digit levels for the Singapore banks in 4Q25



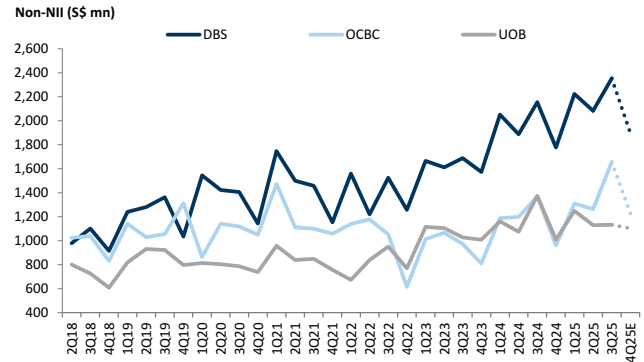
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: NIMs to remain largely flattish in 4Q25 as rebound of HIBOR to help offset impact from lower SORA



Source: MAS, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

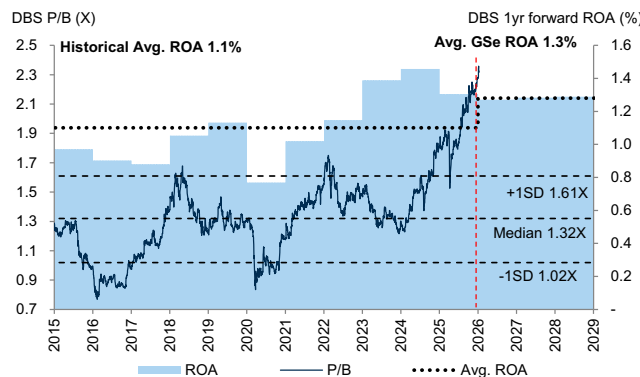
Exhibit 7: We estimate non-NII to taper due to seasonality



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

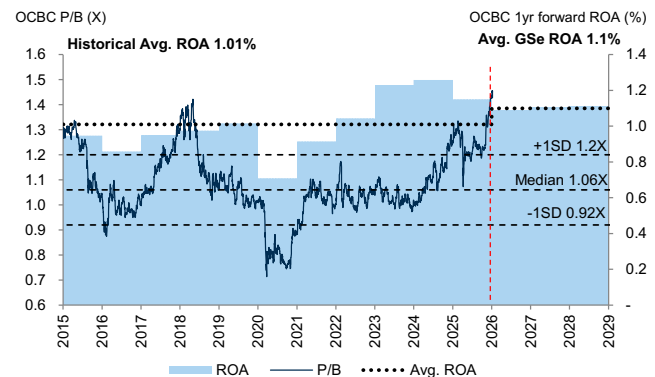
Valuation

Exhibit 8: DBS is trading more than 1St.Dev below its 10-year historical median on P/B...



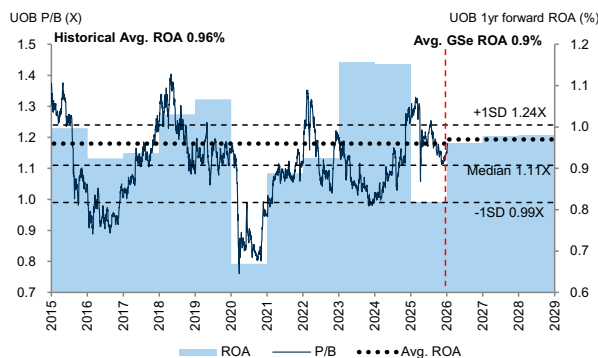
Source: Company data, Thomson Reuters, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 9: ...so is OCBC



Source: Company data, Thomson Reuters, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 10: UOB is trading above its 10-year historical median on P/B



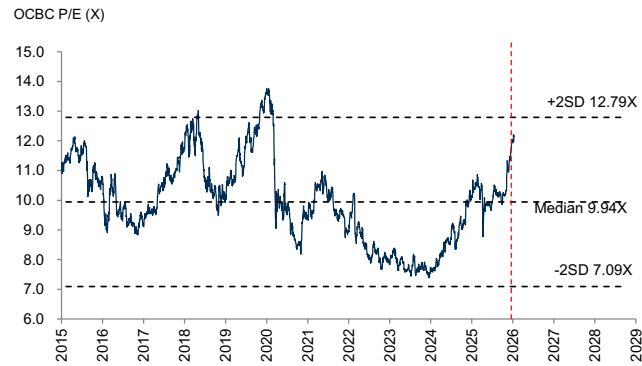
Source: Company data, Thomson Reuters, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: DBS is trading more than 2 St.Dev below its 10-year historical median on P/E



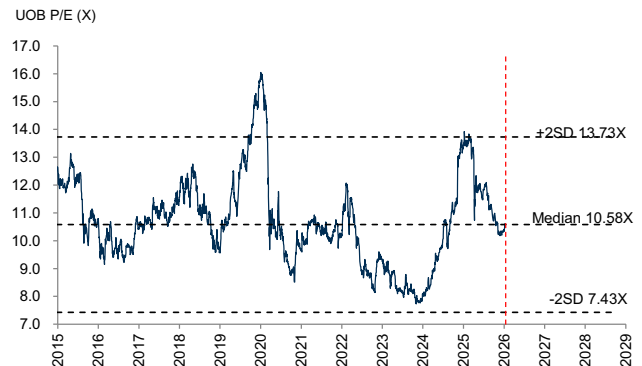
Source: Company data, Thomson Reuters, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: OCBC is trading close to 2 St.Dev below its 10-year historical median on P/E



Source: Company data, Thomson Reuters, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 13: UOB is trading at its 10-year historical median on P/E



Source: Company data, Thomson Reuters, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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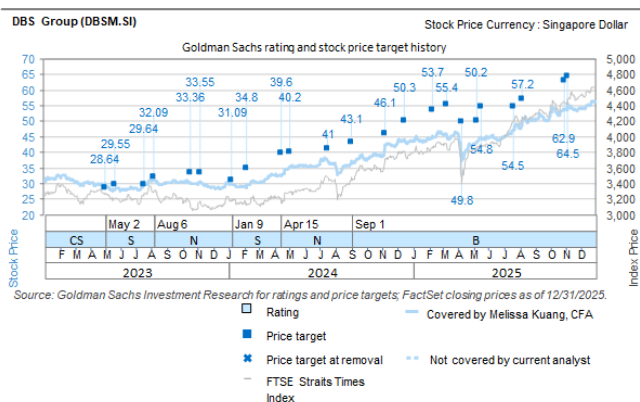
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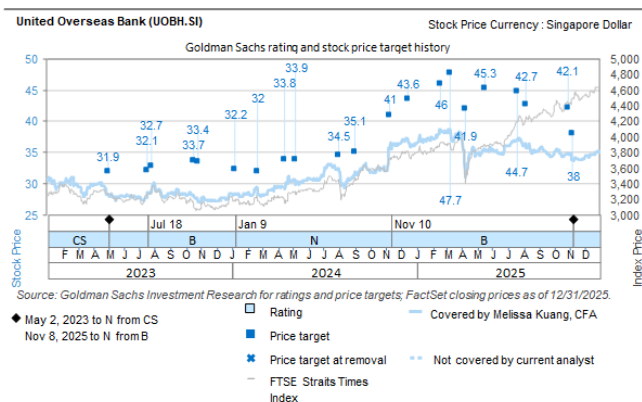
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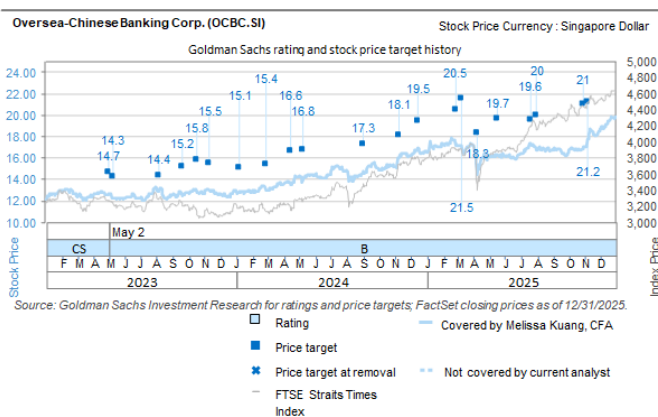
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